This Version: October 3, 2026
Latest Version: here

TIM DE SILVA

Email: tdesilva@stanford.edu
Website: www.timdesilva.me
Twitter/X: @timdesilva
GitHub: timhdesilva

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

2025-	Assistant Professor of Finance, STANFORD UNIVERSITY, GRADUATE SCHOOL OF BUSINESS
2026–2027	Spence Faculty Scholar, STANFORD UNIVERSITY, GRADUATE SCHOOL OF BUSINESS
2025-	Faculty Affiliate, STANFORD HUMAN-CENTERED ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE INSTITUTE
2025-	Affiliated Researcher, MIT SLOAN CONSUMER FINANCE INITIATIVE
2024-2025	Postdoctoral Fellow, STANFORD UNIVERSITY, INSTITUTE FOR ECONOMIC POLICY RESEARCH
2022-2026	Honorary Appointment, UNIVERSITY OF TECHNOLOGY SYDNEY
2022-2025	Visiting Scholar, AUSTRALIAN NATIONAL UNIVERSITY

EDUCATION

2024	Ph.D. in Management (Finance) MASSACHUSETTS INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY, SLOAN SCHOOL OF MANAGEMENT *Dissertation Committee*: Taha Choukhmane, Jonathan A. Parker (Co-Chair), Lawrence D.W. Schmidt, Eric C. So, David Thesmar (Co-Chair)
2021	M.S. in Management Research MASSACHUSETTS INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY, SLOAN SCHOOL OF MANAGEMENT
2018	B.A. in Financial Economics and Applied Mathematics, *magna cum laude* CLAREMONT MCKENNA COLLEGE *Thesis Supervisor*: Fan Yu

WORKING PAPERS

1. Making Room on an Empty Planet: The Spatial Consequences of Depopulation, with James D. Paron.
2. AI Financial Advice: Supply, Demand, and Life Cycle Implications, with Taha Choukhmane, Weidong Lin, and Matthew Akuzawa
   - Winner of *Swiss Finance Institute Outstanding Paper Award*
3. Expectations Formation with Fat-Tailed Processes: Evidence and Theory, with Adam Rej, Eugene Larsen-Hallock, and David Thesmar.
   - Winner of *Cognitive Foundations in Finance Best Paper Award*
4. Selective Inattention to Interest Rates, with Pierfrancesco Mei.
   Reject and Resubmit, The American Economic Review.

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

5. What Drives Investors' Portfolio Choices? Separating Risk Preferences from Frictions, with Taha Choukhmane
The Journal of Finance, 2026, 81 (1): 5-48.

6. Losing is Optional: Retail Option Trading and Expected Announcement Volatility, with Eric C. So and Kevin C. Smith.
The Review of Finance, 2026, 30 (2), 489-535.

   - Winner of *IQAM Best Paper Award*

7. Insurance versus Moral Hazard in Income-Contingent Student Loan Repayment
The Quarterly Journal of Economics, 2025, 140 (4): 2851-2905.

   - Winner of *BlackRock Applied Research Award*, *Top Finance Graduate Award*, *FRA Best Paper Award*, *Michael J. Barclay Young Scholar Award*, *Brattle Group PhD Candidate Award*, *USC Marshall School of Business Trefftzs Award for Best Student Paper*

8. Noise in Expectations: Evidence from Analyst Forecasts, with David Thesmar
The Review of Financial Studies, 2024, 37 (5): 1494-1537.

   - Runner-Up for *Michael J. Brennan Best Paper Award*

OTHER PUBLICATIONS AND INACTIVE WORKING PAPERS

9. Age, Evolving Allocation Preferences, and the Case For Personalized Solutions, with Sudipto Banerjee, Louisa Schafer, and Taha Choukhmane
T. Rowe Price Research Paper, 2025.

10. Model-Agnostic Dynamic Programming, with Marc de la Barrera.

11. Are Volatility Expectations in Different Countries Interdependent? A Data-Driven Solution to Structural VAR Identification for Implied Equity Volatility Indices
Undergraduate Economic Review, 2017, 14.

    - Winner of Claremont McKenna College *Best Senior Thesis in Financial Economics*

12. Is Google Search Behavior Related to Volatility? Incorporating Google Trends Data into a GARCH Model for Equity Volatility
Undergraduate Economic Review, 2016, 13.

SOFTWARE PACKAGES

`nndp`	Dynamic Programming with Neural Networks (joint with Marc de la Barrera) Source code: `GitHub`, `PyPI`

AWARDS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND GRANTS

2026	Spence Faculty Scholar (2026–2027), IQAM Best Paper Award, Cognitive Foundations in Finance Conference Best Paper Award, Swiss Finance Institute Outstanding Paper Award
2025	Michael J. Brennan Best Paper Award (Runner-Up), Stanford IFDM Research Funding Grant
2024	Top Finance Graduate Award, SFS Cavalcade PhD Travel Grant, Brattle Group PhD Candidate Award for Outstanding Research, USC Marshall School of Business Trefftzs Award for Best Student Paper
2023	Winner of BlackRock Applied Research Award, FRA Best Paper Award, Michael J. Barclay Young Scholar Award, NBER Household Finance Grant ($15,000), Mark Kritzman and Elizabeth Gorman Finance PhD Research Fund, MIT Sloan Stone Fund (x2), Thomas Anthony Pappas Endowed Scholarship Fund
2022	Mark Kritzman and Elizabeth Gorman Research Fund (joint with Taha Choukhmane)

2018-2024 MIT Sloan PhD Fellowship

2018 Phi Beta Kappa, Robert Day School BA Scholar, International Honor Society of Economics (Omicron Delta Epsilon), Best Senior in Economics, Best Senior Thesis in Financial Economics, Dean's List (Top 15%)

OTHER POSITIONS

2024- US Census Bureau Special Sworn Status (SSS)

2018-2022 Research Assistants for Taha Choukhmane, Eben Lazarus, and Eric C. So

2017 Institutional Equity Derivatives Trading and Research, Morgan Stanley

2016 Quantitative Investment Researcher, Analytic Investors

2016 Research Assistant at the Lowe Institute of Political Economy

2016-2018 Director, Claremont Consulting Group

2015-2016 Lead Consultant, Claremont Consulting Group

PRESENTATIONS (INCLUDES SCHEDULED)

2026 *Seminars*: Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia (x2), Duke Economics, CIBC Finance Innovations & AI Seminar, NYU Stern, Harvard Business School, Stanford AFTLab FinTech Seminar
Conferences: CEPR 11th European Workshop on Household Finance, FMG Conference on Cognitive Foundations of Finance, WFA, NBER SI Household Finance, Stanford SITE Public Economics, SIEPR Conference on Budget Analysis and Public Policy, NBER Macroeconomic Effects of Population Aging, CQA Fall Conference, Wharton-ICI Conference on AI and Finance

2025 *Seminars*: BYU, Berkeley Haas, Washington Foster, T. Rowe Price Research Group, BlackRock, Federal Reserve Board of Governors, Berkeley Economics
Conferences: AFA, Q Group (Spring), Stanford Financial Education Symposium, NBER Behavioral Finance (Spring), BFI Conference on Rational Inattention, WFA, NBER SI Forecasting & Empirical Methods, SITE Financial Regulation, SITE Macroeconomics of Uncertainty and Volatility, NBER Monetary Economics (Fall), NBER Asset Pricing (Fall)

2024 *Seminars*: Chicago Booth, Princeton, Yale SOM, Harvard Business School, Harvard Economics, London School of Economics, London Business School, Wharton, UCLA Anderson, Stanford GSB, Northwestern Kellogg, Berkeley Haas, Columbia Business School, NYU Stern, Boston College Carroll, Bocconi, OSU Fisher, Claremont McKenna College, USC Marshall
Conferences: Top Finance Graduate Award Conference (HEC Paris), SFS Cavalcade, WFA, Policy Impacts Annual Conference, SITE Market Failure and Public Policy, Swedish House of Finance Workshop on Household Debt Relief, Brookings New Doctoral Research in Tax Policy & Public Finance, NBER Public Economics (Fall), NBER Economics of Education (Fall), SIEPR Financial Literacy Colloquia, e61 Micro 4 Macro Conference

2023 *Seminars*: Inter-Finance PhD Seminar
Conferences: Olin Finance Conference (PhD Poster Session), Financial Research Association (FRA) Conference, BlackRock Applied Research Award Panel

2022 *Seminars*: Quantbot Technologies, Inter-Finance PhD Seminar
Conferences: WFA, BSE PhD Workshop on Expectations in Macroeconomics

2021 *Conferences*: Transatlantic Doctoral Conference, SoFiE Annual Conference

2020 *Conferences*: Stanford GSB Rising Scholars Conference

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Referee *Quarterly Journal of Economics, Journal of Political Economy, American Economic Review, Review of Economic Studies, Journal of Finance, Review of Financial Studies, Journal of Financial Economics, Journal of Political Economy Macroeconomics, American Economic Journal: Economic Policy, Review of Economics and Statistics, Management Science, Journal of Financial Econometrics, Journal of Banking and Finance, Journal of Accounting and Economics, The Accounting Review*

Program Committee MFA 2025, SFS Cavalcade 2025, WFA 2025, FMA 2025, NFA 2025, SFS Cavalcade 2026, WFA 2026, EFA 2026, FMA 2026, WFA 2027

SKILLS

Software PYTHON, FORTRAN, C++, OPENMP, MPI, OPENACC, GIT, BASH, SLURM, R, SAS, STATA, BLOOMBERG TERMINAL, LaTeX

Languages English (native), Spanish (beginner)

OTHER ACTIVITIES

Auto Racing FIA International Class B License (2017-), FIA Silver Driver Categorisation (2024-), *Team USA Scholarship* Nominee (2015), *Team USA Scholarship* Finalist (2016), 5x Formula 2000 Track Record Holder (2016-2017), Pacific F2000 Pro Series Champion (2016), *Mazda Road to Indy $250,000 Shootout* Competitor (2016), *Motorsports Magazine* Silverstone Classic Driver of the Weekend (2022)

Golf Ocean League Conference Individual Champion (2012, 2014), NCAA Division III National Team Champion (2016)

PERSONAL INFORMATION

Ethnicity: Sri Lankan, White. Citizenship: USA.